

## 1990

# The World Wide Web

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### May: Finally A Good Windows

The era of Microsoft dominating the PC took off with the introduction of Windows 3.0. It was launched on 22nd May 1990, and rivalled the Macintosh and Amiga on the GUI front.

The biggest advantage of Windows 3.0 was that it could be used with different PC processors and could run on the 80386, 80286, and below. When run on the 386, the speed and stability it offered were unparalleled.



The Windows 3.0 splash screen

Its MS-DOS file manager/program launcher was replaced with Program Manager, thereby simplifying the process of viewing and launching files and applications. Like in the Macintosh, all system settings were relocated to one place on the OS called the Control Panel. All this came bundled with a text editor called Notepad and a simple word processor software called Write. There were two games pre-packaged in the OS—Reversi and Solitaire.

Around 1991, multimedia extensions were released to support sound cards, graphic cards and CD-ROM drives. Microsoft sold more than 10 million copies of Windows 3.0.

### September: The Archie Search Engine

The Web's first search engine was Archie. It was nothing like today's Google or Yahoo! or Live Search; it was an archive that catalogued a list of FTP sites and requested for updates once every